ROLEEDGE · CAREER

Resume & LinkedIn Toolkit

How to Build a Career Brand That Gets Noticed and Shortlisted

14	12	Print
SECTIONS	EXERCISES	WITH SPACE TO WRITE

How to use this guide: print it, work through it in order, and write in the spaces. Every exercise has room for your answers, and you can print extra copies of any page.

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From **RoleEdge**, founded by Mayank Kapoor, former Manager at Bain & Company and Warwick MBA. Free to use and share.

Why Resumes and LinkedIn Are Your Career Brand

Your resume and LinkedIn are not documents—they're your **career storefront.** Before recruiters speak with you, they look at these two things. A polished resume gets you interviews; a strong LinkedIn gets you discovered.

Think of it as inbound vs outbound marketing:

- Resume = outbound → you apply.
- LinkedIn = inbound → recruiters find you.

REFLECTION

Which one is currently stronger for you—resume or LinkedIn?

Resume Basics: Structure & Format That Work Globally

Recruiters often spend **only seconds** on a first resume scan. Keep it clean:

- Font: Calibri/Arial, 11–12 pt.
- Length: 1 page (US, UK), 2 pages (Europe, India for >8 years exp).
- Sections: Summary, Experience, Education, Skills, Certifications.

✗ Don't include photos, DOB, marital status (except where required like Germany).

EXERCISE

Audit your resume for formatting errors. Note the three biggest fixes.

1.
2.
3.

Crafting a Powerful Professional Summary

Your summary = your elevator pitch. It must:

- Highlight years of experience.
- Mention industries and skills.
- Position you for target roles.

> EXAMPLE
>
> "Strategy consultant with 7 years' experience across two global consulting firms, specializing in digital transformation and market entry. MBA from Warwick. Seeking leadership roles in consulting or corporate strategy."

EXERCISE

Write a 3-sentence professional summary.

Writing Impact-Driven Bullet Points

The difference between a weak resume and a strong one is **impact.**

WEAK "Worked on client presentations."

STRONG "Developed client presentations on digital strategy, influencing a $25M implementation."

Formula = Action Verb + Task + Impact + Number.

EXERCISE

Rewrite 1 bullet from your resume with measurable results.

	My bullet
Before	
After	

Resume Do's and Don'ts for Consulting, Finance, and Tech

- **Consulting:** Highlight problem-solving, frameworks, client impact.
- **Finance:** Emphasize modeling, valuations, transactions.
- **Tech:** Showcase product ownership, data-driven decisions, coding/project tools.

DON'T list generic skills like "hardworking."

DO quantify every bullet.

EXERCISE

Pick 1 bullet and tailor it for a consulting OR finance OR tech role.

LinkedIn Basics: Headline, Summary, and Experience

Your LinkedIn headline is SEO gold.

BAD "Analyst at Deloitte."

GOOD "Strategy Consultant | Digital Transformation | Ex-Deloitte | MBA Warwick."

Your summary should be future-facing.

EXERCISE

Write one headline that positions you for your dream role.

Optimizing LinkedIn for Recruiter Search (Keywords + SEO)

LinkedIn works like Google. Recruiters search with keywords: "Data Analyst SQL Python." If those words aren't in your profile, you won't show up.

Tips:

- Use keywords in headline, summary, skills.
- Add the skills that matter for your target role (LinkedIn allows up to 100).
- Endorse colleagues, get endorsements back.

EXERCISE

Search a dream job description. Extract 5 keywords and add them to your LinkedIn profile.

1. _____
2. _____
3. _____
4. _____
5. _____

Building Social Proof: Recommendations & Endorsements

Recommendations = credibility. Get them from managers, clients, colleagues.

> EXAMPLE
> "Priya rebuilt our reporting process in three months and made every client review easier to run. She is the analyst I'd hire again first."

EXERCISE

Ask 1 ex-colleague for a LinkedIn recommendation today.

_____

_____

_____

_____

Showcasing Projects, Publications, and Thought Leadership

LinkedIn allows you to feature:

- Projects (consulting cases, strategy reports).
- Certifications.
- Publications/blogs.

This makes you **more than just a job title.**

EXERCISE

Add 1 project to your LinkedIn "Featured" section.

Personal Branding on LinkedIn: Posts & Articles

Posting regularly builds brand. Content ideas:

- Career learnings.
- Industry insights.
- Case prep tips.
- Personal milestones (MBA admit, job offer).

REMEMBER

Consistency beats virality.

EXERCISE

Draft 1 post idea you could share this week.

Resume Templates (Chronological, Functional, Hybrid)

- **Chronological:** Best for linear careers.
- **Functional:** Best for career breaks/pivots.
- **Hybrid:** Best overall—skills + timeline.

WORKSHEET

Pick 1 format and explain why it suits you.

LinkedIn Optimization Checklist

- [ ] Headline = targeted + keyword-rich.
- [ ] Summary = story + career goals.
- [ ] Experience = quantified bullets.
- [ ] Skills = relevant and endorsed.
- [ ] Recommendations = 2–3 strong ones.

EXERCISE

Score your profile from 1 to 10 on each element, and note one fix.

Element	Score (1–10)	One fix
Headline		
Summary		
Experience		
Skills		
Recommendations		

EXAMPLE

Worked examples

An illustrative example. Names and details are representative, not real clients.

Resume rewrite: Aarav's generic Big Four resume was reframed with quantified bullets, and he was shortlisted by a strategy consulting firm.

LinkedIn branding: Sarah rewrote her headline and shared five posts on fintech, and recruiters from large tech companies started reaching out.

Your 90-Day Resume and LinkedIn Plan

Your plan

When	Focus	My actions
Weeks 1–4	Rewrite your resume bullets	
Weeks 5–8	Optimise LinkedIn for search	
Weeks 9–12	Post regularly and collect recommendations	

My notes

NEXT STEP

Want someone to check your work?

Bring this guide to a free call with RoleEdge. We'll go through your answers and help you plan what comes next.

Book a free call at roleedge.com/book